LIFA MBANGATA

Software Developer - Backend & Full-Stack

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Cape Town, South Africa

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

ICT (Applications Development) graduate from Cape Peninsula University of Technology (CPUT) with professional experience developing full-stack software solutions and business applications. Skilled across backend and frontend development, with experience in Java, Spring Boot, React, JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, SQL, REST APIs, messaging, caching, authentication, and modern cloud and DevOps tools. Experienced in translating business requirements into practical software solutions, working in agile teams, solving technical problems, and delivering client-focused applications. Seeking graduate, internship, or junior Software Developer opportunities.

EDUCATION

Diploma in ICT (Applications Development) 2023 - 2026

Cape Peninsula University of Technology (CPUT)

Relevant Coursework: Object-Oriented Programming; Data Structures & Algorithms; Software Design & Architecture; Databases & Data Modelling; Web Application Development; Mobile Application Development; Agile Software Development; Domain-Driven Design; Test-Driven Development; Design Patterns; System Design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages Java - Python - JavaScript - TypeScript - SQL

Frontend React

Backend & Frameworks Spring Boot - Spring Security - Node.js - Express.js

APIs & Architecture REST APIs - Object-Oriented Programming - MVC - Client-Server Architecture

Messaging & Cache RabbitMQ - Redis - WebSocket / STOMP

Auth & Security JWT - Refresh Token Management - Role-Based Access Control

Databases & Storage MySQL - PostgreSQL - Firebase - Room Database - SQL

Cloud & DevOps Vercel - Render - Railway - AWS S3 - Supabase - CI/CD

Testing & Engineering JUnit (TDD) - Agile/Scrum - TDD - DDD - Design Patterns - Clean Code - System Design

Tools Git - GitHub - Postman - Maven - Vite - Android Studio - Docker - Excel

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CAPACITI July 2025 - June 2026

Software Developer

- Contributed to the development and maintenance of production-ready applications using React and Spring Boot, supporting 100+ internal users.
- Supported secure RESTful backend services with Spring Security, including role-based access control.
- Integrated frontend components with backend APIs and contributed to performance improvements.
- Collaborated in agile development teams through sprint planning, daily stand-ups, and peer code reviews.
- Diagnosed and resolved application defects across development and testing cycles.
- Applied clean code, testing, and documentation practices to improve maintainability and team onboarding.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Employee Attendance Management System

Software Developer - Client Project | 2026

Java 17 - Spring Boot - React - Vite - Tailwind CSS - Recharts - Axios - Maven - REST APIs

- Delivered a full-stack attendance management and reporting system for a client, covering CSV ingestion, attendance calculation, incident detection, data aggregation, and reporting.
- Built Spring Boot and Java 17 REST APIs for CSV upload, health checks, company reports, employee reports, and department summaries.
- Developed a responsive React dashboard with attendance analytics, department comparisons, employee reports, incident analysis, and interactive charts.
- Implemented payroll-grade time calculation and automated attendance incident detection for short time, extra time, and attendance exceptions.
- Completed the application and prepared it for cloud deployment.

3D T-Shirt Customisation Application

Software Developer - Full-Stack

React - Spring Boot - Spring Security - Git

- Developed a full-stack application enabling real-time 3D product customisation using React and Spring Boot.
- Implemented secure authentication and data persistence with Spring Security.
- Designed modular, component-based frontend architecture and followed clean code practices.

Task Manager Application

Software Developer - Full-Stack

React - Node.js - Express.js - REST APIs

- Designed and implemented a REST-based full-stack application using React, Node.js, and Express.js.
- Built reusable UI components and integrated frontend and backend services for task creation, updates, and tracking.

Timetable Management System

Software Developer

Java - Java Swing - SQL - Relational Database - DAO

- Led development of a Java Swing application to manage and visualise timetable data.
- Designed the relational database schema and DAO layer and coordinated sprint planning and code reviews.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Hackathon Winner - 2nd Annual AfriHack Hackathon

Recognised for developing and presenting an innovative technology solution in a competitive, time-constrained hackathon environment.

REFERENCES

Omphile Ranstwele

CAPACITI

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Additional references available on request.